Phishing Awareness Training

Recognizing and Preventing Phishing Attacks

Cybersecurity Awareness Project

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Introduction
Phishing

- Phishing is a cyberattack in which criminals pretend to be trusted people or organizations to trick victims into revealing sensitive information.
- They want your passwords, bank financial information, personal information, access to account and computer system.
- Phishing can happen through emails, text messages, phone call, and social media.

Type of Phishing

- Email phishing: fake emails designed to steal information.
- Smishing: phishing messages sent through SMS or text messages.
- Vishing: Fraudulent phone call used to trick the victims.
- Spear phishing: messages targeted at a specific person or organization.
- Clone phishing: A fake copy of a genuine message containing a suspicious link or attachment.

Red Flags

- Unusual messages: unexpected spelling mistakes, strange wording, or request that don’t make sense.
- Requests for sensitive information: someone ask for your password, bank details, or verification code.
- Unexpected attachments: files arrive from unknown senders.
- Strange links: the link address does not match the official website
- Urgent messages: “your account will be closed immediately!”
- Suspicious senders: the email address or phone looks unfamiliar.

Spot a Fake Website

- Check the spelling of the website’s domain.
- Preview a link’s actual destination before opening it.
- HTTPS encrypts a connection; it doesn’t prove the site is genuine.
- Open the organization’s official site or app directly.
- Avoid unexpected downloads.
- Example
- Suspicious: paypaI-example.com
- The letter “I” in this example could be mistaken for a lowercase “l”.
- Safety Tip: Never enter your password or banking information on a website you have not verified.

Social Engineering tactics

Social engineering is when attackers manipulate people into revealing confidential information or performing unsafe actions.

Common Tactics

* Fear: Threatening to suspend an account.

* Urgency: Demanding immediate action.

* Impersonation: Pretending to be a bank employee, boss, or IT support worker.

* Rewards: Offering fake prizes or gifts.

* Curiosity: Using tempting messages or unexpected attachments.

Example Scenario

You receive an email claiming that your bank account will be blocked in 10 minutes unless you click a link and verify your password.

What should you do?

Do not click the link. Contact your bank through its official app, website, or phone number.

Key Lesson: Stop, think, and verify before you act.

How to Protect Yourself from Phishing

Best Practices for Staying Safe Online

* Verify the sender: Confirm unexpected requests through a trusted channel.

* Think before clicking: Check links and attachments before opening them.

* Use strong passwords: Create unique passwords for each account.

* Enable multi-factor authentication (MFA): Add another layer of account protection.

* Update your devices: Install security updates for your operating system, browser, and applications.

* Use security software: Keep reputable antivirus and security tools updated.

* Protect personal information: Never share passwords, PINS, or verification codes with untrusted people.

* Report suspicious messages: Notify your IT or security team when appropriate.

Remember: Pause, verify, and report suspicious activity.

What to Do if You Receive a Phishing Message

Steps to Take

1. Do not click: Avoid suspicious links and attachments.

2. Do not reply: Don’t respond to suspicious messages or share personal information.

3. Verify the message: Contact the supposed sender through a trusted channel.

4. Report it: Use your email provider’s phishing-report option or notify your organization’s IT/security team.

5. Delete or quarantine it: Follow your organization’s reporting procedure before removing the message.

6. If you clicked a link: Stop interacting with the website and report the incident.

7. If you shared your password: Change it immediately using the official website and enable MFA. Change it anywhere else you reused it.

8. If you shared financial details: Contact your bank immediately.

Important: Report mistakes quickly. Early reporting can help reduce damage.

Phishing Scenario

An employee receives an email claiming to be from the IT department.

Email message:

“Your company account will be disabled today. Click the link below to verify your password immediately.”

Warning Signs

* The message creates a sense of urgency.

* It requests a password through a link.

* The sender’s identity has not been verified.

* The link may lead to a fake login page.

Discussion Questions

1. What signs suggest this email could be phishing?

2. What should the employee do next?

3. Who should receive a report about this message?

Correct Response: Do not click the link or enter your password. Verify the request through an official IT channel and report the suspicious email.

Key Takeaways

Remember These Cybersecurity Rules

* Recognize suspicious emails, links, and attachments.

* Verify the sender before trusting a message.

* Never share passwords, PINS or verification codes.

* Use strong, unique passwords and enable MFA.

* Report suspicious messages to the appropriate team.

* Act quickly if you accidentally share sensitive information.

The Golden Rule

STOP. THINK. VERIFY. REPORT.

Your security awareness can help prevent a cyberattack.

THANK YOU!

Stay Alert. Stay Secure.

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Think Before You Click

Quick Phishing Check

You receive an unexpected email asking you to open an attachment to “verify your account.” What should you do?

A. Open it quickly before the account is blocked
B. Don’t open it; verify the request through a trusted channel
C. Forward it to friends to ask if it looks real

Correct answer: B
Why: Unexpected attachments can be dangerous. Verify the request using contact details you already trust.